September: The Dalai Lama visits Beijing where he meets Mao Zedong, Zhou Enlai, and Deng Xiaoping.

1955

April: An array of newly independent nations meets in Bandung, Indonesia, to establish the Non-Aligned Movement.

1956

February: The Khampas of Tibet begin to resist the Chinese occupation. The US Central Intelligence Agency clandestinely supports them.

March: A rebellion breaks out among the Nagas in easternmost India.

November–December: The Dalai Lama goes on a pilgrimage to India.

1957

India discovers that China has built a highway through Aksai Chin. China also builds new roads inside Tibet, including roads towards the Indian border.

1958

Mao Zedong launches his ‘Great Leap Forward’ to modernize the Chinese economy. It turns out to be a disaster.

1959

10 March: An uprising breaks out in Lhasa against China’s occupation of Tibet. The Dalai Lama flees to India. In the same month, a split begins to occur between the Soviet Union and China.

25 March: Deng Xiaoping states that China will ‘settle accounts’ with India. China begins to prepare for war with India by sending Tibetan-speaking spies into NEFA’s Tibetan-speaking areas where they survey the terrain and collect other intelligence.

25 August: Chinese troops attack an Indian position at Longju in NEFA, killing two Indian soldiers.

21 October: Chinese troops attack an Indian position at Kongka La in Ladakh, killing 17 Indian soldiers.

1960